

Research Statement

My long-term goal is to build systems that can *understand, reason, plan, and develop physical intuition* about the world while remaining *efficient, scalable, and controllable*.

Toward **superhuman intelligence** through **efficient, scalable, and controllable** generative and world models.

Toward this goal, my work spans *one-step generative modeling* through *pretraining* and *distillation* (ECCV, NeurIPS, and ICCV), efficient *megapixel-scale synthesis* that roughly halves 4K latency (NeurIPS), and *controllability* and *safety* (ICCV and CVPR), including protection of photos against unauthorized image-to-video generation.

Education

Johns Hopkins University

Doctor of Philosophy, Electrical and Computer Engineering

Research: **Generative and World Models**

Aug 2026 – expected 2030

Advisor: Professor Vishal M. Patel

Research Experience

Qualcomm AI Research

Predoctoral Researcher

3 yrs 1 mo · Aug 2023 – Aug 2026

- **Six publications**, including **five first-authored**, in generative modeling at ECCV, CVPR, ICLR, 2×NeurIPS, and ICCV.
- **Two U.S. patents**.
- Recipient of the 2025 **Outstanding Resident** in Research and Applied Demo Award, Qualcomm AI Residency Program.
- Advised by **Principal Scientist Dr. Anh Tran**. Completed intensive PhD-level training in a selective research residency, conducting research from problem formulation and experimental design to rigorous evaluation and publication.

Selected Publications

(*) denotes equal contribution

ECCV 2026 POSTER SLIDES	Cross-Space Distillation: Teaching One-Step Students with Modern Diffusion Teachers Anh Nguyen* , Ngan Nguyen*, Duc Vu*, Trung Dao, Viet Nguyen, Quan Dao, Kien Nguyen, Chi Tran, Phong Nguyen, Khoi Nguyen, Cuong Pham, Dimitris Metaxas, Vishal M Patel, and Anh Tran QUALCOMM JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY RUTGERS UNIVERSITY UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON
NeurIPS 2026	UltraFlash: Accelerating Megapixel Visual Synthesis Phuc Lai*, Anh Nguyen* , Phong Nguyen, and Anh Tran QUALCOMM
NeurIPS 2025 POSTER SLIDES	Improved Training Technique for Shortcut Models Anh Nguyen* , Viet Nguyen*, Duc Vu, Trung Dao, Chi Tran, Toan Tran, and Anh Tran QUALCOMM
CVPR 2026 POSTER SLIDES	Anti-I2V: Safeguarding your photos from malicious image-to-video generation Duc Vu, Anh Nguyen , Chi Tran, and Anh Tran QUALCOMM
ICLR 2026	Revisit Visual Prompt Tuning: The Expressiveness of Prompt Experts Anh Nguyen* , Minh Le*, Huy Nguyen, Chau Nguyen, Anh Tran, and Nhat Ho QUALCOMM THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN
ICCV 2025 POSTER SLIDES	Supercharged One-step Text-to-Image Diffusion Models with Negative Prompts Anh Nguyen* , Viet Nguyen*, Trung Dao, Khoi Nguyen, Cuong Pham, Toan Tran, and Anh Tran QUALCOMM